

LAKE FOREST CULTURAL DISTRICT

A Focused Path Forward

Board working session · Resubmission strategy



NATURE



WATER



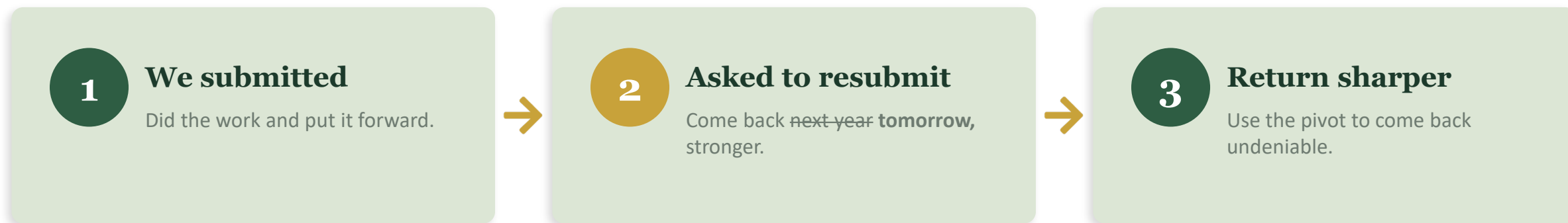
CULTURE

June 2026

Where we are

On Monday, we were asked to **resubmit next year**.

That's *runway* — not rejection*.



The real problem isn't the calendar.

We've asked others to believe in this district before we agreed, among ourselves, on what we're actually trying to accomplish — or on one message to carry.

*I must frame this with the truth about our current position. However I think it can be reversed, not just in a year in a day, tomorrow.

What this program actually is

Act 298 of 2007 — a place-based revitalization tool. Not a festival budget.



Original-art sales-tax exemption

ELIMINATED · JAN 2025

Act 11 (signed Dec. 2024) removed the state AND local exemption. Sellers now charge full sales tax on original art.



Historic rehabilitation tax credit

ACTIVE THROUGH 2028

The live financial tool in our hands — real money for owners who restore the buildings along our corridor.

The festival version of a cultural district no longer exists in law. *The rehabilitation version does.*

The tool in our hands

State Commercial Historic Tax Credit



25%

of rehabilitation costs returned as a credit (35% in rural areas)



Sellable

credits are fully transferable to another taxpayer



5 years

to use them — the credit carries forward



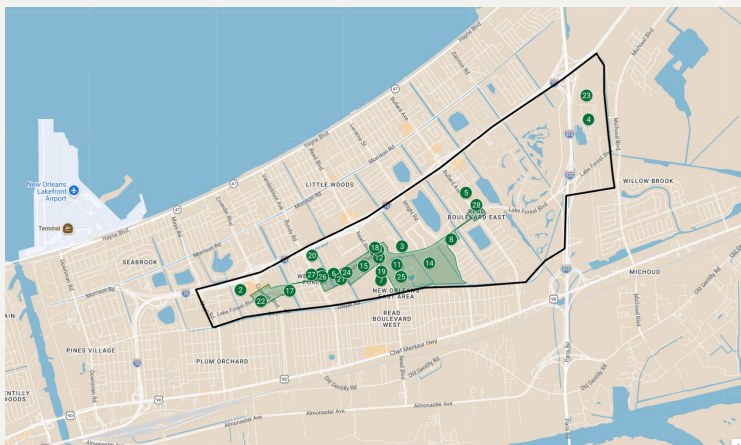
2028

available through Dec. 31 — the program's sunset

Eligible: income-producing buildings 50+ years old, inside the district, with projects over \$10,000.

The pitch: a focused footprint

BEFORE



Spread across large residential areas that don't directly benefit.
Hard to message. Hard to deliver.

NOW

A focused corridor: Crowder → Bullard



~3 walkable miles along the old main street, anchored by Joe Brown Park & the Nature Center — putting the credit to work on buildings already eligible.

Smaller map. Sharper aim.

The ask

If we agree tonight, here's how we move.



Lock one message + one map — tonight

Agree the focused corridor, then build a simple old-map vs. new-map graphic to share.



Take it to Jason

A real path to get development moving by ~~next year~~ **Friday** — and it covers no large residential areas.



Re-engage the state with receipts

Bring Francesca Vega an example of how we would perform real reporting + assessment plan, not just a story.



Start the asset assessment now

Show the exact properties we're targeting. Prove we do the work.

If the answer is resubmit, we use the ~~year~~ tomorrow to come back undeniable.